

A Sheaf of Roses



Elizabeth Gordon

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A Sheaf of Roses

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*A
Sheaf of Roses
by
Elizabeth Gordon*

*Illustrations by Frederick W.
Martin*

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*This book is
dedicated to all
kindred spirits
who love the
beautiful in
Nature; and is
especially
inscribed to my
loyal friends of
the Pacific coast.*

*Elizabeth
Gordon*

A Sheaf of Roses

*The rose was born of
lovers' sighs,
Of lovers' tears and sobs,
And deep within its glowing
heart*

*The heart of true love
throbs;
Each rose that blooms an
emblem is*

*Of love divine and true,
And I have made a sheaf of
them*

To send, with love, to you.

A Bunch of Roses

*Better than gifts of gleaming
gold,*

Or houses made by hands;

*More precious than the
glowing gems*

Men seek in distant lands;

Breathing of love and purity,

*Of constant hearts and
true;*

*A bunch of roses, God's own
gift,*

All wet with heaven's dew.



White Cherokee

*An angel on her way to
heaven,*

*One perfumed, starlit night,
Remembered one she'd left
behind,*

*And pausing in her flight,
Looked back to earth, and
shed a tear*

*For love left all forlorn.
Behold! Where fell that pearly
drop*

*A pure white rose was
born.*



Cecil Bruner

*Two men there were in
olden days*

Who loved each other well.

*To each man was the same
fair maid*

*Dearer than words could
tell.*

*One kissed her hand and rode
away,*

*His heart with sorrow
fraught;*

*Around that cottage threshold
grew*

*The rose called "Friendly
Thought."*



Frau Karl Druski

*A mother heard the war
god call*

*Her well-loved first-born's
name.*

*With lips that smiled, but
heart that bled,*

*She heard his dream of
fame.*

*She pinned the colors on his
breast*

*And watched him march
away;*

*The rose they call "The
Mother's Prayer"*

Blossomed that fateful

day.



White Banksia

*One journeyed to a foreign
land*

To teach the love of God.

*The thorns of ignorance and
strife*

Beset the path he trod.

*His prayer for faith and
strength went up*

*To Him who hears all
woes;*

*An answering sign to him was
sent—*

*The sweet White Banksia
Rose.*



Rose of Old Castile

*A proud Castilian beauty
left*

*Her home in sunny Spain,
And went with him who held
her heart*

*A fairer home to gain.
To strange new lands the good
ship sailed,*

*And where she touched
her keel
There grew, in token of young
love,*

The Rose of Old Castile.



Safrano

*A Spanish maid of high
degree*

Lived in her patio.

*Suitors she had, but none
could touch*

*The maid's pure heart of
snow.*

*There came a gallant from the
wars*

*Who'd vanquished all his
foes;*

*He won her heart, and from
her blush*

Grew the Safrano Rose.

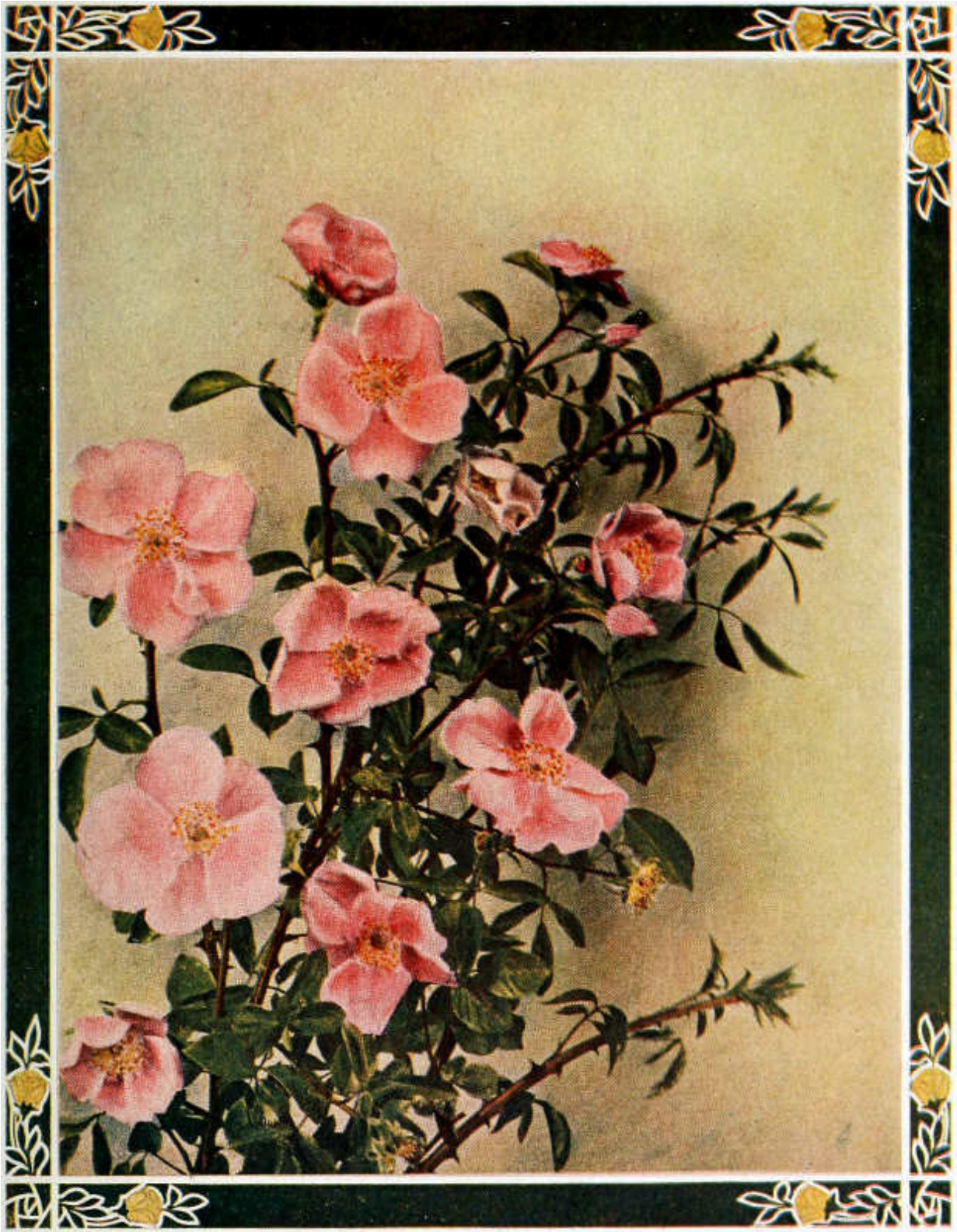


Pink Cherokee

*A tender, yearning mother-
soul*

*Whose life had never known
The blessing of a baby's heart
Beating against her own,
Found, rosy, smiling, at her
door*

*A babe of mystery;
There bloomed the rose of
mother love,
The rare Pink Cherokee.*



Jacqueminot

*A boy and girl, from
infancy*

*Playmates, good comrades
too,*

*Walked hand in hand one
summer day*

*A rare old garden through;
A meadow lark full-throated
sang*

*His love song to the morn;
The crimson Jacqueminot
grew there,*

*For there new love was
born.*



Gold of Ophir

*A dark-eyed Indian
princess*

*Was wooed, so legends say,
By a brave and gallant soldier
Who loved and rode away;
Under the shadow of the hills
Capped by eternal snows,
She sleeps, enwrapped and
sheltered by
The Gold of Ophir Rose.*



Ragged Robin

*A dusky baby came to
share*

*A gypsy's caravan,
The dark-eyed mother loved
the child*

*As only mothers can.
She laid him 'mongst the
grasses, where*

*The south wind softly
blows;
Love's angel sent to mark the
spot*

The Ragged Robin Rose.



Killarney

*A bonnie Irish lassie
Followed her sweetheart
true*

*To distant shores, where
homesick tears*

*Bedimmed her eyes of
blue;*

*The Little People heard her
plaint,*

*And pitying her woes,
They planted as a sweet
surprise*

The pink Killarney Rose.



Marie Van Houte

*Upon a cactus-covered hill
Facing the ocean blue,
A shining cross was raised
aloft*

*By one whose heart was
true;*

*The seeds of faith he
scattered where*

*The western sunset glows,
Took root and grew, and
blossomed in*

The Crucifixion Rose.



American Beauty

*Where great ambitions swirl
around*

*A teeming, toiling mart,
A gray-haired gardener
worked and hoped,*

*Love's fair dream in his
heart;*

*The vision bright he
cherished, till*

*With velvet leaves
uncurled,*

*A perfect rose rewarded him—
Love's gift to all the world.*



The Rainbow Rose

*The rainbow, on a summer
day,*

Glowing against the sky,

Was filled with pity as it heard

A hapless lover's sigh;

A shower of sympathy it sent

To compass him around.

Where fell those drops of

kindly balm

*The Rainbow Rose was
found.*



Sweet Brier Rose

*Some love the spot where
lilies fling*

Their subtly sweet perfume;

*Some love the languorous
lotus, with*

Its oriental bloom;

*But drifting downward
through, the years,*

*My loyal memory goes
To where my childhood's
treasure lives—*

The wild Sweet Brier Rose.



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The Table of Contents was added for ease of navigation.

The poem text uses the browser's script or cursive font. This can be changed if it does not match the large initial capital letter well. A popular and freely available script font (as of 2015) is 'URW Chancery L'.

On page 26, two instances of 'Jacqueminot' have been replaced with 'Jacqueminot'.

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